

Skydo

Winning Freelancers at the First Invoice

How Skydo's pricing compares on small invoices, and one idea

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\$257

Below this invoice size, a freelancer keeps more money with PayPal than with Skydo

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Fees as listed on each provider's website, 26 Sep 2026

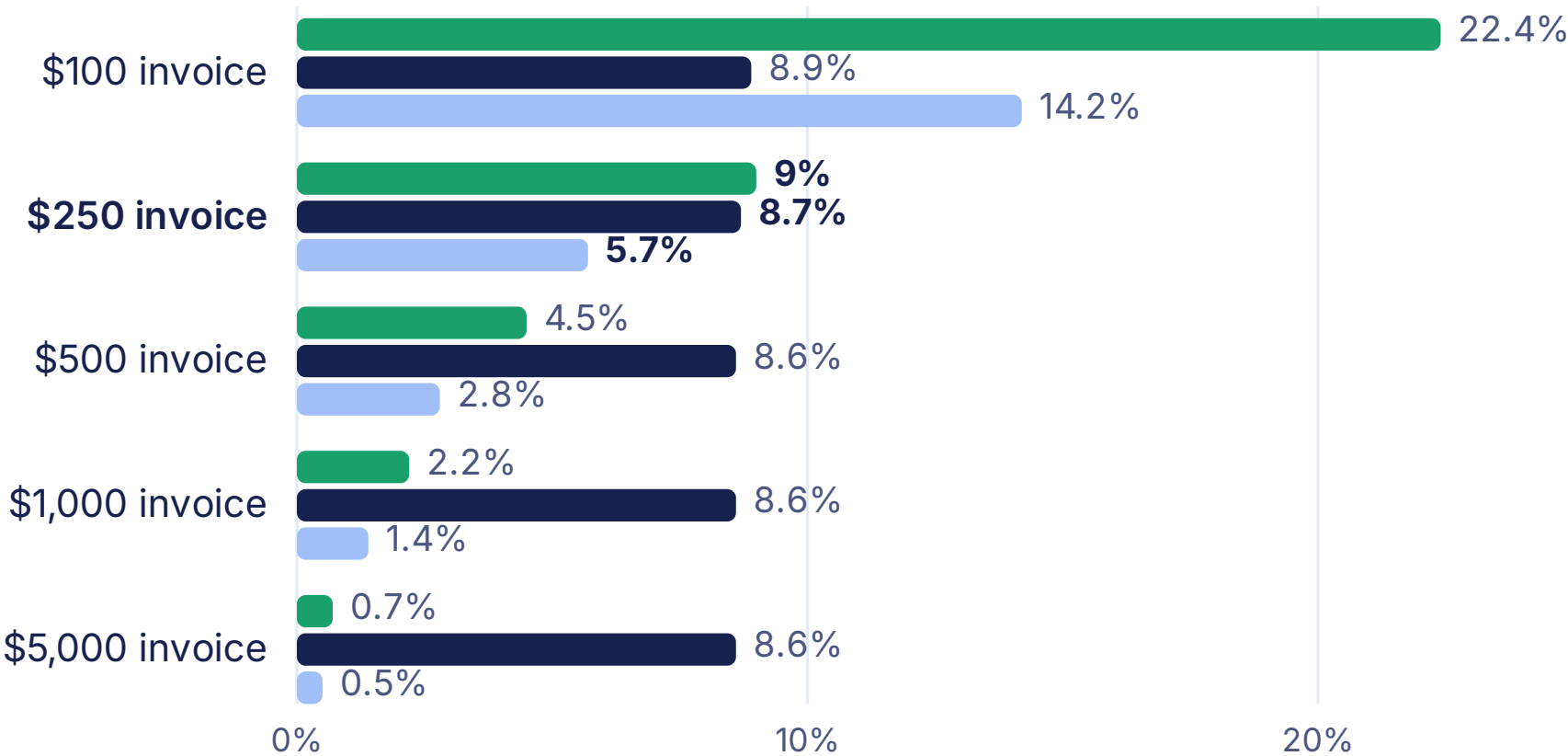
Overview

Skydo's flat fee is a great deal on a \$5,000 invoice. On a **\$200 invoice it takes about 11%**, more than PayPal. Freelancers usually start with small invoices, so this is where a small change could win them early.

Effective fee by invoice size

Fee as a share of the invoice, including 18% GST on fees and the FX markup.

■ Skydo ■ PayPal ■ Xflow



\$257

Below this invoice size, a freelancer keeps more money with PayPal than with Skydo

\$7,250

Below this size, Xflow's listed fee is lower than Skydo's at every invoice amount

2% ≤ \$19

Proposed starter fee for small invoices, which joins the current \$19 fee exactly at \$950

Source: fees as listed on the Skydo, PayPal and Xflow websites on 26 Sep 2026. All figures include 18% GST on fees and any FX markup.

How fees compare

Effective fee % at each invoice size

Lowest of the three current providers in green. Starter is the proposed Skydo tier.

INVOICE	SKYDO	PAYPAL	XFLOW	STARTER (PROPOSED)
\$100	22.4%	8.9%	14.2%	2.4%
\$250	9.0%	8.7%	5.7%	2.4%
\$500	4.5%	8.6%	2.8%	2.4%
\$1,000	2.2%	8.6%	1.4%	2.2%
\$2,000	1.1%	8.6%	0.7%	1.1%
\$5,000	0.7%	8.6%	0.5%	0.7%
\$10,000	0.3%	8.6%	0.5%	0.3%

Skydo: \$19 up to \$2,000, \$29 up to \$10,000, 0.3% above, zero FX markup. PayPal: 4.4% + \$0.30, 3.0% conversion spread. Xflow: the lower of its Starter and Growth plans.

Why this matters

Skydo's comparison pages say PayPal costs 5–8% of the invoice value, which holds for large invoices. For small ones the flat fee turns the comparison around: at \$100, Skydo takes 22% of the invoice and PayPal takes about 9%.

New freelancers often send their first few invoices for a few hundred dollars. If they compare fees at that point, Skydo may miss them before they grow into the \$2,000+ invoices where it leads.

A freelancer who moves to Xflow over a \$12 vs \$19 difference is unlikely to switch back later, because changing payment details means asking every client to update theirs.

Above \$7,250, Skydo is the cheapest of the three. The strength is real, and it sits with larger exporters and agencies.

A Starter tier for small invoices

2% of the invoice amount, capped at \$19, for invoices under \$950. At \$950 the 2% fee equals \$19, so the new tier meets current pricing with no step and nothing changes for invoices above it.

- 1** At \$200 the fee drops from \$19 to \$4, bringing Skydo from about 11% to 2.4% including GST, which is cheaper than both PayPal and Xflow.
- 2** Revenue on existing large-invoice customers is untouched.
- 3** It needs a cost check first: I don't know Skydo's cost to process one inward payment. With a \$3 minimum, a \$100 invoice would cost 3.5% including GST, still well below PayPal (8.9%) and Xflow (14.2%).

A \$200 invoice today and with Starter

PROVIDER	FEE	FEE %
Skydo today	\$22.42	11.2%
PayPal	\$17.50	8.7%
Xflow	\$14.16	7.1%
Skydo Starter (proposed)	\$4.72	2.4%

All figures include 18% GST on fees.

How I'd know it worked Share of new signups who receive their first payment within 30 days.